CHAPTER 1

Posture & Hand Shape

Lesson Book + Workbook



Print double-sided (flip on the long edge). Each Lesson Book page is on the left and its Workbook page faces it on the right, with the same page number. Read the left page, then do the right one.

CHAPTER 1

Posture & Hand Shape



Sit tall, like a puppet on a string

Before the first note: how to sit, and how to hold your hands. Get these right, and every note after them is easier.

In this chapter

Sit at the piano	page 2
Let the arm carry the hand	page 3
A round hand	page 4
Finger numbers	page 5
Play: finger walks	page 6
My five checks	page 7

By the end, you can

- [ ] sit at the right height and distance
- [ ] move your hand with the whole arm
- [ ] make a round hand and play on the tips
- [ ] say every finger number, on both hands

Goes with: the Workbook page beside each lesson page, and the online lesson (scan the code below).

TEACHER This chapter is the base for every other one. The five checks on page 7 come before every time at the piano, for every student at every level, not only for beginners.

Try it in the app

CHAPTER 1

Posture & Hand Shape

Each workbook page faces its Lesson Book page: read the left page, then do the right one.

Your map for this chapter

One lesson step at a time: read it, do its page, try it online. Tick each step when the page is done.

1 · LESSON BOOK
Read one step with your teacher.

→

2 · WORKBOOK
Do that step's page: TOGETHER, AT HOME, PLAY.

→

3 · APP
Scan the page's code: try the step, then play the drill.

→

4 · CHECK-UP
Page 7, in the lesson, when every step is done.

Lesson step	Workbook page	What it covers	Done
Step 1	page 2	Sitting at the piano	☐
Step 2	page 3	The arm leads	☐
Step 3	page 3	The arm leads	☐
Step 4	page 4	A round hand	☐
Step 5	page 5	Left hand, right hand · Finger numbers	☐
Step 6	page 5	Left hand, right hand · Finger numbers	☐
Step 7	page 6	Finger walks	☐
Step 8	in the app only		☐

ONLINE

The drill

Scan, then pick a level. Aim for 9 out of 10.

1. Is the stool set up right? best ___/10
2. Spot the hand-shape fault best ___/10
3. Which finger? best ___/10

At the piano

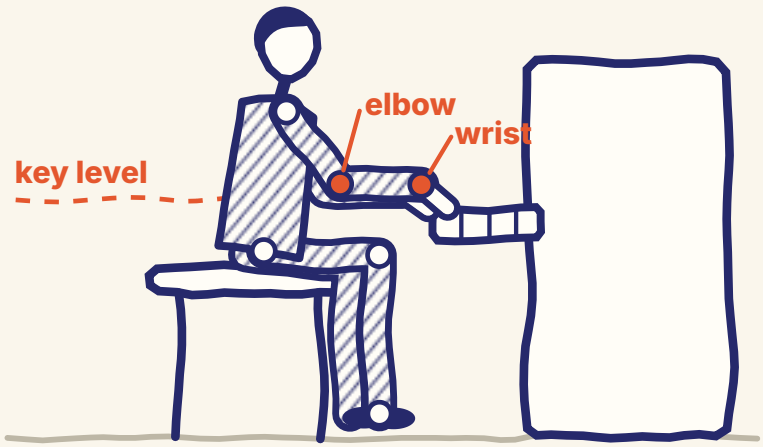
Real-piano missions for this chapter. Tick one box each time you do it with your teacher or at home.

1	Before you play, every time: front half of the stool, feet flat, sit tall, leaning a little toward the piano.	☐	☐	☐	☐
2	The six warm-ups in order, from the big parts of the body to the small.	☐	☐	☐	☐
3	A round hand on your knee, like holding a ball, then onto the keys. The wrist stays free, as if on a roller.	☐	☐	☐	☐
4	Finger walks: one note, then two, three, four, five. A little rainbow from key to key.	☐	☐	☐	☐

★ **All steps ticked?** Do the Chapter check-up on page 7 in your lesson, then colour in the badge.

Step 1

Sit at the piano

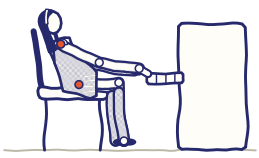


Two things to set: **how high** and **how far**. Your forearm is level with the keys, and your elbows sit just in front of your body.

At the piano

1. Sit on the **front half of the stool**, feet flat on the floor, leaning a little toward the piano. ☐
2. Raise or lower the stool until your **forearm is level** with the keys. ☐
3. Slide in or out until your **elbows are just in front of you**, about a fist away from your sides. ☐

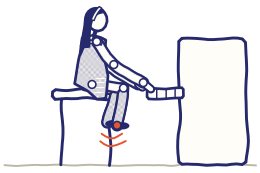
Not like this



× Leaning back, like on a sofa



× So close the elbows squash in



× Too high: feet swinging

REMEMBER **Front half of the stool, feet flat, sit tall, leaning a little forward.**

TEACHER Watch for elbows squashed in (too close) or arms reaching out (too far). Feet dangling? A footstool or a sturdy box fixes it. Say: "Sit tall, like a puppet on a string."

Lesson step 1 Set _____ Due _____ 10 min · scan → step 1 online first · drill level ___ best ___/10

TOGETHER Is this a good set-up?

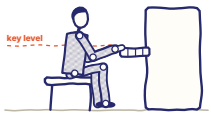
Look at each picture with your teacher, then try it at the piano. Circle the tick or the cross.

EXAMPLE



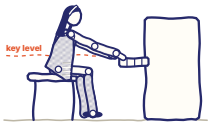
✓ ✗

2



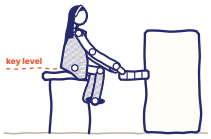
✓ ✗

3



✓ ✗

4



✓ ✗

AT HOME Set up at home

Before you practise, set up and tick each one. Ask someone at home to check, or use a mirror.

	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri
Front half of the stool	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Feet flat, leaning a little toward the piano	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Sit tall, like a puppet on a string	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Forearm level with the keys	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Elbows away from your body	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

★ PLAY Draw yourself at the piano

Draw yourself sitting at the piano. Then colour a star for each thing you drew.

☆ sitting tall
☆ feet flat
☆ leaning a little forward
☆ elbows away from the body
☆ round hands

How did it feel? Circle one. 🙂 😐 ☹ Teacher ☐

Step 2

Let the arm carry the hand

Your fingertips stay connected to the piano, but the **whole arm** does the work: from above, it leads the hand and the fingers. Six moves, **in this order**, from the big parts of the body to the small ones: each one gets the arm ready for the next.



1 Rag doll

Flop forward and let both arms hang heavy. Shake them loose, then float the hands up and set them gently on the keys.



2 Elbow wings

Check the elbows are free, not stuck to your body: let them float out like wings, then back. Stop in the middle, a fist from your body.



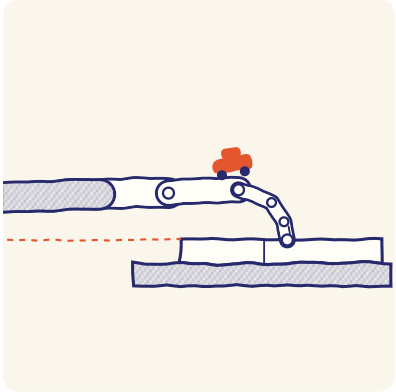
3 Arm glide

Now the whole arm: skate along the keys. The round hand rides on the arm to the next group of keys. The fingers ride, they don't walk.



4 Arm drop

Lift the whole arm and let it drop into a key on finger 3: firm tip, soft wrist, a round sound.



5 Knuckle bridge

Check the bridge: your knuckles are a bridge a little car can drive over. Press one key slowly and hold for 3: the bridge stays up.



6 Wrist balloon

Check the wrist never sinks: as the key goes down, a balloon lifts the wrist straight back up to level. The fingertip stays on the key.



REMEMBER **The arm leads from above, elbows free. Even while a finger presses a key, the whole arm stays free.**

TEACHER Do all six in this order: each one checks something the next one needs. After every key, watch the wrist: it comes straight back up to level and never sinks. Say: "Arms heavy, like wet spaghetti. Now rest them on the keys."

Lesson step 2-3 Set ____ Due ____ 10 min · scan → step 2 online first · drill level ___ best ___/10

TOGETHER Put the warm-ups in order

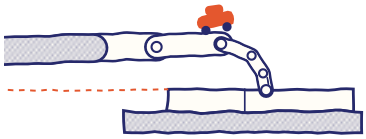
Big parts of the body first, small parts last. Write 1 to 6 under the pictures. The first one is done.

EXAMPLE



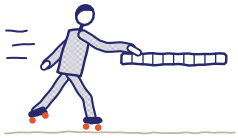
Rag doll **1**

2



Knuckle bridge ☐

3



Arm glide ☐

4



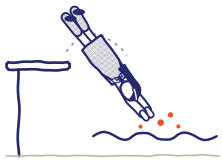
Wrist balloon ☐

5



Elbow wings ☐

6



Arm drop ☐

AT HOME My warm-ups this week

Do the six in order before you practise. Tick a box for each one you did.

	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
1 Rag doll	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
2 Elbow wings	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
3 Arm glide	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
4 Arm drop	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
5 Knuckle bridge	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
6 Wrist balloon	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

AT HOME Yes or no?

Circle yes or no.

1 **The arm leads from above.** yes no

2 **My elbows stay stuck to my body.** yes no

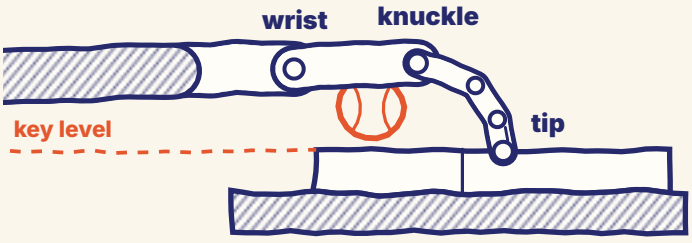
3 **Even while a finger presses a key, the whole arm stays free.** yes no

4 **After a key goes down, my wrist sinks below the keys.** yes no

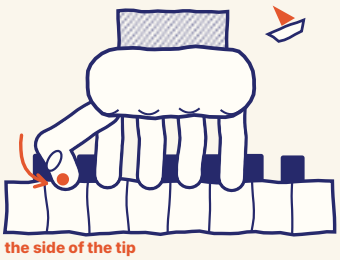
How did it feel? Circle one. ☺ 😐 ☹ Teacher ☐

Step 3

A round hand



Round, like holding a ball



The thumb bends in and plays on the side of its tip, like a tipped boat

Let your arms hang, then lift your hands as if you were holding a small ball. Keep that shape when the hand goes on the keys. **Knuckles up** like a bridge, and play on the **fingertips**. The wrist stays free: with the fingertip on the key, the hand can sway up and down and side to side, as if a **roller** sat under your forearm.

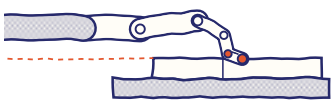
At the piano

1. Hands on your knees. Hold an imaginary ball. ☐
2. Move the ball shape onto the keys without squashing it. ☐
3. Play one key with each finger, on the tip. The knuckles stay up. ☐
4. Fingertip on a key: sway the wrist up and down, then side to side, as if on a roller. Notice the knuckles and the tip, and try not to let them cave in. ☐

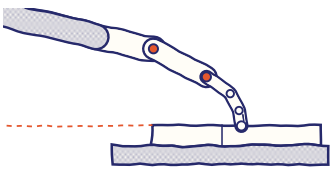
Not like this



× Flat fingers



× Tip joint caving in



× Wrist stiff and high

REMEMBER **A free wrist, as if on a roller. Keep an eye on the knuckles and fingertips.**

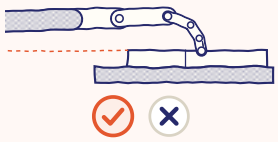
TEACHER Watch the tip joint, especially on finger 5: for now, just help the student notice it. Say: "Hold a little bubble in your hand. Don't pop it!"

Lesson step 4 Set _____ Due _____ 10 min · scan → step 4 online first · drill level ___ best ___/10

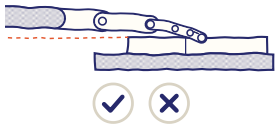
TOGETHER Spot the good hand

Circle the tick for the good hand shape and the cross for a fault. Then tell your teacher what is wrong.

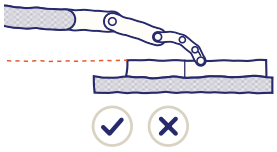
EXAMPLE



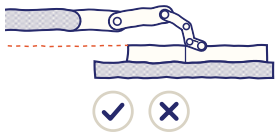
2



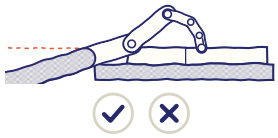
3



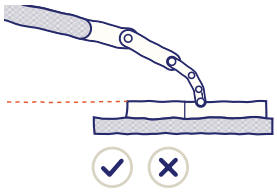
4



5



6



AT HOME Roller wrist and thumb

Do each one at the piano and tick a box each day.

	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri
Fingertip on a key: sway the wrist up and down, then side to side	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Knuckles up, like a bridge	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The thumb bends in and plays on the side of its tip	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

★ PLAY Hold the bubble

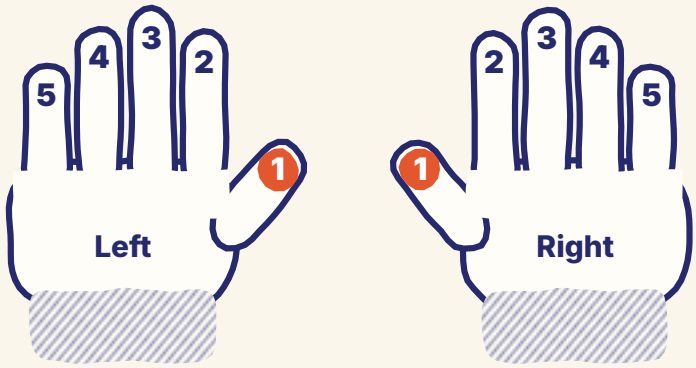
Hold a small ball (or a mandarin) in a round hand. Draw your hand round it, then colour a star for each.

- ☆ knuckles up
- ☆ round fingers
- ☆ playing on the tips
- ☆ the thumb on its side

How did it feel? Circle one. Teacher ☐

Step 4

Finger numbers



Every finger has a number, **1 to 5, starting from the thumb**. It's the same on both hands: both thumbs are 1, and both little fingers are 5.

1 Captain Thumb · **2 Pointer** · **3 Tall Middle** · **4 Shy Ring** · **5 Baby Pinky**

The mirror game

1. Hold both hands up. Wiggle each finger as you say its number. ☐
2. Your teacher calls "Right hand, 3!" and you wiggle it. Try ten calls. ☐
3. Swap: you call the finger, and your teacher wiggles it. ☐



REMEMBER **Fingers are numbered 1 to 5 from the thumb, on both hands.**

TEACHER Watch for the left hand numbered from the little finger. Say: "Thumbs are always 1. Your hands are mirror twins."

Try it in the app

Lesson step 5-6 Set _____ Due _____ 10 min · scan → step 5 online first · drill level ___ best ___/10

TOGETHER Which finger?

Write the number of the coloured finger. Thumbs are 1 on both hands.

EXAMPLE



4

2



3



4



5



6



★ PLAY Trace your hands

Put each hand flat in its box and draw round it. Write the finger numbers on every finger -- the thumb is 1 on both hands! Then draw a ring on each finger 4.

Left hand

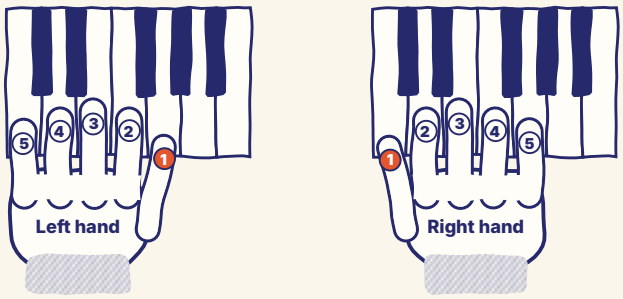
Right hand

Check: ☐ 5 fingers on each hand ☐ Thumbs are 1 ☐ A ring round each finger 4
☐ Left and right the right way round

Play

Finger walks

Now put it together: sit well, make a round hand, and play. **Start small:** one note, then two, three, four, and all five. From key to key, the hand draws a little **rainbow**: relaxed, never squeezed tight, the whole hand helping. **One circle is one steady beat.**





Hop on 3

one note: an arm drop on every 3

3 ○ 3 ○ | 3 3 3 ○



Neighbours

two notes, next door, taking turns

2 3 2 3 | 3 2 3 ○



Up and back

three notes: up, then back down

1 2 3 ○ | 3 2 1 ○



Little hill

four notes: up the hill and down

1 2 3 4 | 3 2 1 ○



Stairs and slide

all five: up the stairs, then down the slide

1 2 3 4 5 ○ | 5 4 3 2 1 ○

An empty dashed circle means: hold the note for one more beat.



REMEMBER **A little rainbow from key to key. Relaxed: the whole hand helps.**

TEACHER Right hand first, then left hand, then together if it is easy. Move on to the next tune only when the hand stays round. Any five white keys near the middle will do; your teacher shows where to put the hand, and the letter names come in chapter 3.

Lesson step 7 Set _____ Due _____ 10 min · scan → step 7 online first · drill level ___ best ___/10

TOGETHER Fill in the missing numbers

Write the missing finger numbers in the coral circles, then play the tune. The first one is done.

Up and back (1) (2) (3) ( ) | (3) ( ) (1) ( )

Little hill (1) (2) ( ) (4) | ( ) (2) (1) ( )

Stairs and slide (1) (2) (3) ( ) (5) ( ) | (5) ( ) (3) (2) (1) ( )

AT HOME Finger walks this week

Play each tune. Tick it when the hand stays round and draws a little rainbow from key to key.

	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri
1 Hop on 3	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
2 Neighbours	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
3 Up and back	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
4 Little hill	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
5 Stairs and slide	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

★ PLAY Make your own finger walk

Write a finger number (1 to 5) in each circle. Leave a circle empty to hold the note. Play it to your teacher!

( ) ( ) ( ) ( ) | ( ) ( ) ( ) ( )

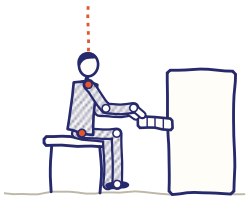
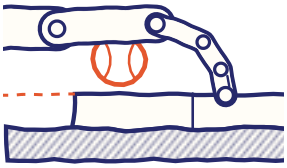
My tune is called _____

How did it feel? Circle one. 🙂 😐 ☹ Teacher ☐

Step 5

My five checks

Before you play, every time. Give yourself a star for each check in each lesson.

	Lesson 1	2	3	4	5	6
 **Front half of the stool**	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
 **Feet flat, leaning a little toward the piano**	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
 **Sit tall, like a puppet on a string**	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
 **Forearm level with the keys, elbows away from your body**	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
 **Round hand, play on the tips**	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

REMEMBER **Check your posture before every practice.**

TEACHER At the start of each lesson, the student says the five checks out loud while doing them; you only correct. When all five are easy, do the Chapter check-up in the Workbook.

Chapter check-up

In the lesson -- no help, no piano -- about 10 minutes

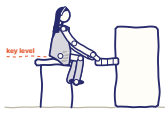
Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 24

A A good set-up? Circle the tick or the cross.

1 

2 

3 

4 

B The arm: yes or no?

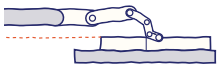
5 I squeeze hard to play loud. yes no

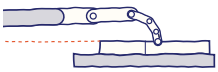
6 Even while a finger presses a key, the whole arm stays free. yes no

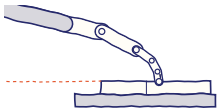
7 The arm leads from above. yes no

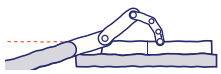
8 After a key goes down, my wrist sinks below the keys. yes no

C A good hand shape? Circle the tick or the cross.

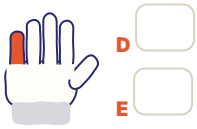
9 

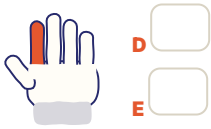
10 

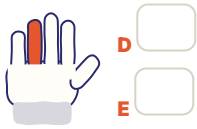
11 

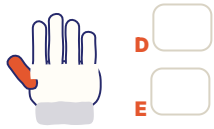
12 

D Left or right hand? Write L or R. E Which finger is coloured?

13 · 17 

14 · 18 

15 · 19 

16 · 20 

F Finger walks: write the missing number.

21 (1) (2) (3) ( ) (5)

22 (5) (4) ( ) (2) (1)

23 (2) (3) (2) ( )

24 (1) ( ) (3) (2) (1)

Concept	Score	Pass mark	Passed?
A Sitting at the piano	___ / 4	3+	☐
B The arm leads	___ / 4	3+	☐
C A round hand	___ / 4	3+	☐
D Left hand, right hand	___ / 4	3+	☐
E Finger numbers	___ / 4	3+	☐
F Finger walks	___ / 4	3+	☐

Chapter complete! Every concept passed? Colour in the badge and add your name to it.